

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

• Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Let's discuss some important matters!



Learning Outcome

Exchange advice and suggestions in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What do you think you usually talk about in the office?
- What topics do you think you should avoid talking about in the office?

Can Do Statements

- I can change topics in a conversation.
- I can show understanding of someone's situation/ feelings.
- I can talk about jobs and work.

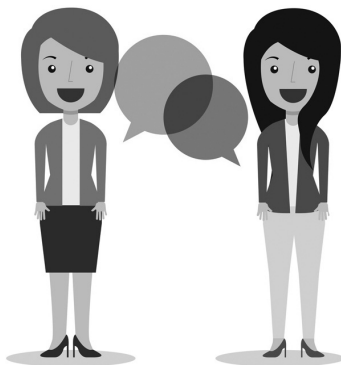




Let's Explore!

Miranda is **on pins and needles***! Why?

* "On pins and needles" is an expression that means you are very anxious while you are waiting to find out something.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Janet:** Hello Miranda. I've called you in to review our overall progress.
- Miranda:** I see. Where should we begin?
- Janet:** Well, I haven't seen Peter in a few days. I am starting to get worried that the proposal hasn't been put forward.
- Miranda:** Well, he's been quite focused since I dropped Greta's name the other day. He knows she shares his skill set.
- Janet:** He must be feeling nervous.
- Miranda:** But returning to your point, his proposal is looking good.
- Janet:** Glad to hear. On another note, how is Ferdinand? I haven't seen him since the meeting.
- Miranda:** Perhaps because he's been working so hard on punctuality. He's no longer in the hallways at irregular hours. Ferdinand is taking his new task pretty seriously. I think he's thrilled to channel his PR skills into a South American context.
- Janet:** You were right to recommend him. Good work. To change the subject, how's the new printer?
- Miranda:** Functions like a dream. What a relief!
- Janet:** You can say that again! And now you, Miranda. I'm not concerned about your progress - I know it's all up to speed. How are you feeling about things?
- Miranda:** Honestly, until we have the proposal completed and hear back from Farmani I'm on pins and needles.
- Janet:** I know exactly what you mean. Our success doesn't revolve around Holly's, but we're all anxious to know which direction we're headed in.
- Miranda:** That's it exactly. Well, we should know soon!





Let's Practice!

Janet wants to change the subject. What should she say?

Instructions: Read the phrases. Put them into the correct box. (Changing the Subject / Returning to the Subject). Use the sentences to model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

- To change the subject, how's the new printer?
- On another note, how is Ferdinand?
- But returning to your point, his proposal is looking good.
- And now you, Miranda.
- Anyway, have you finished writing that?
- By the way, we need to discuss Greta's progress.
- As I was saying, the proposal needs to be completed.

Changing the Subject

Returning to the Subject



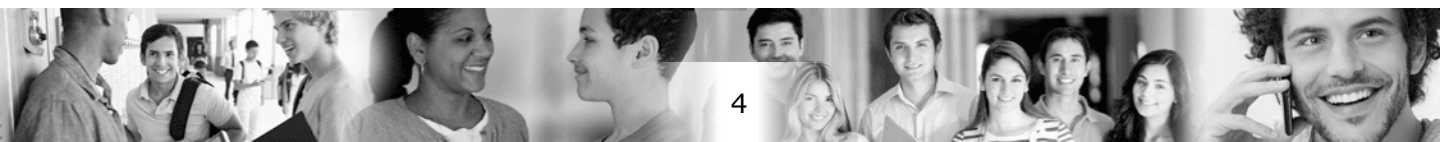
Let's Practice!

Janet or Miranda shows that she understands. What does she say?

Instructions: Read the dialogue. Complete the gaps with the dialogue replies. Use the expressions below. Use the sentences to model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

must be feeling nervous
I know that you mean.
I see. Where should we begin
You can say that again

1. **Janet:** I've called you in to review our overall progress.
Miranda: _____.
2. **Miranda:** Well, he's been quite focused since I dropped Greta's name the other day.
He knows she shares his skill set.
Janet: Peter _____.
3. **Janet:** How's the new printer?
Miranda: Functions like a dream. What a relief!
Janet: _____!
4. **Miranda:** I'm on pins and needles.
Janet: _____.





Extension Activity

Let's change the topic.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Make a list of 7-10 conversation topics on a piece of paper.
- Start a conversation with a partner using one of the topics.
- When you are ready, change the subject to one of the topics you have on your paper.
- Go back to a topic you were talking about when you can.
- Keep going until you have run out of topics.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I think of conversation topics and start a conversation.

☐ ☐

I change the topic of a conversation.

☐ ☐

I go back to a previous topic in a conversation.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- overall progress** (expression): how far something or someone has come along or progressed
e.g. Let's review our overall progress.
- to put forward** (verb): to propose for consideration
e.g. I hope the proposal has been put forward.
- focused** (adjective): with your attention directed to what you want to do
e.g. Peter seems very focused lately.
- irregular** (adjective): not happening at times that are at an equal distance from each other
e.g. He's no longer in the hallways at irregular hours.
- to drop a name** (verb): to introduce someone into a conversation
e.g. He's been working hard since I dropped Greta's name the other day.
- to channel** (verb): to direct ideas towards a particular thing or purpose
e.g. I think he's thrilled to channel his PR skills into this project.
- up to speed** (expression): performing at an expected rate or level
e.g. I know we're all up to speed.
- skill set** (noun): someone's range of skills or abilities
e.g. He knows that she shares his skill set.



Learning Points

Changing Topics in a Conversation

When speaking a foreign language, especially English, it is important that you acquire a set of conversation strategies which will help you deal with the spontaneity of spoken English. A very important strategy you need to master is changing topics in a conversation. Here are a few expressions you can use to change the subject of a conversation.

Changing the subject	Returning to the subject
• <i>By the way, ...</i> • <i>On another note, ...</i> • <i>Changing the subject,/ To change the subject, ...</i> • <i>On another note, ...</i>	• <i>Anyway, ...</i> • <i>As I was saying, ...</i> • <i>Returning to my point, ...</i>

Examples:

- **To change the subject**, *how's the new computer?*
- **On another note**, *have you finished writing the report?*





Learning Points

Showing Understanding of Someone's Situation and Feelings

When having a conversation in English, it is important to show that you are not only listening to someone explaining or telling you something, but also showing understanding of their situation and or feelings. Below you will find language that you can use to express understanding of someone's situation and/or feelings.

- *I see.* : You use this to show that you are paying attention and to show you understand what the person is saying.

- *"I'd like to talk to you about the new project."*

"I see."

- *I know what you mean.* : You use this to tell someone that you understand their situation well, perhaps because you have had a similar experience.

- *"I'm feeling nervous about this project."*

"I know what you mean."

- Subject + *must be feeling* + adjective : You use this to tell someone that you understand how they or someone else feels.

- *"He seems quite focused today."*

"He must be feeling nervous after what you said."

- *You can say that again.* : You use this to show a strong agreement with what someone has said.

- *"The new employee is really good."*

"You can say that again!"

Other ways of expressing understanding of someone's feelings and situation are:

- I'm not concerned about your progress - *I know it's all up to speed.*

